

more bandwidth.

The address field is invaluable; it helps tabulate exactly how many different individual user requests have been received by a site. By counting how many different IP addresses have been logged, log analysis programs can determine how many different sessions have occurred and how many times a single source has requested access to the site or any one of its pages.

2. ID field (-): This field is usually not used, for security reasons.

3. AuthUser field (-): This field would show up only when the log registers that the user was required to type in a username and a password in order to see the page requested. This field usually reveals the full name of the user who owns the account that is making the HTTP request. Most remote sites don't give out this information for security reasons. If this field is disabled by the host, you see a dash (-) as you do here.

4. Date and time field (15/Jan/2008:11:30:22 -0400): The date and time when the server sent the requested material into the Internet. This field is essential to calculate the time elapsed between two page displays. This, then, can be used to sum up how long a particular user viewed a particular page. The log notes the details in this order:

- Date (15/Jan/2008)
- Time—hours, minutes, seconds (11:30:22)
- GMT offset, meaning the difference in time between the time noted here and the GMT. In this case, the time when the data was served to the user is four hours earlier than GMT.

5. Method field (GET): Gives information about the request itself. For all HTTP requests (the www page requests), this field will always start with the GET command. Most Web pages are served using the GET command in HTTP (which is the language in which Web browsers and Web servers talk to each other). Sometimes, the GET is replaced by POST. The difference here is not so relevant to the guy who's interested in Web statistics, hits and misses, etc. The reason is that POST basically indicates that the forms pass their data “invisibly” to the server, while forms that use the GET method pass the data directly as a part of the URL to the server.

6. Filename field (/stuff/stuff.html HTTP/1.0): This one is self-evident, in the sense that it shows the path and the filename of the